



Individual Instructor Report Summer 2023 Version A for ECO S304L - INTRO TO MACROECONOMICS-WB (79540) (Maria Teresa Sarmiento)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Summer 2023**

Courses Audience: **60**

Responses Received: **20**

Response Ratio: **33.3%**

Report Comments

Results were collected during the implementation of a new course evaluation system.

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

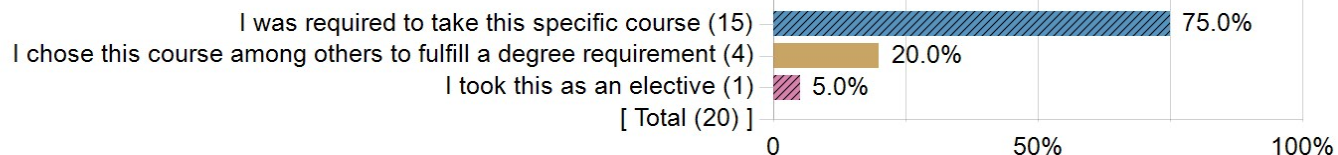
The number of students (e.g. Respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no one method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

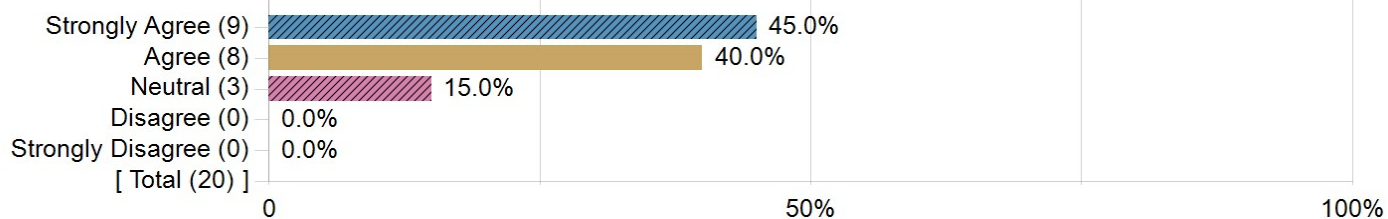
Creation Date: **Friday, August 18, 2023**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



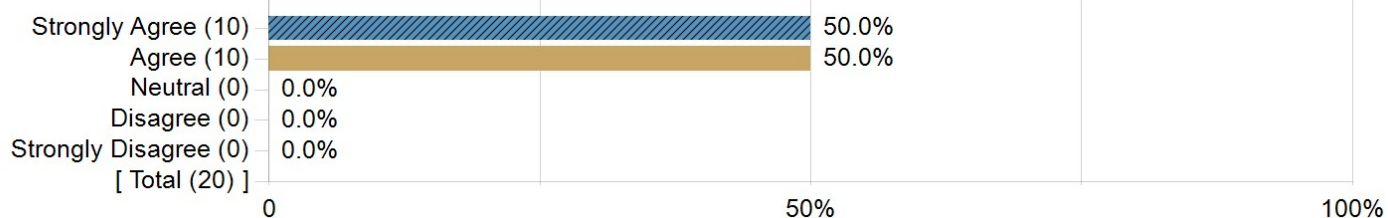
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.30

The course was well organized.



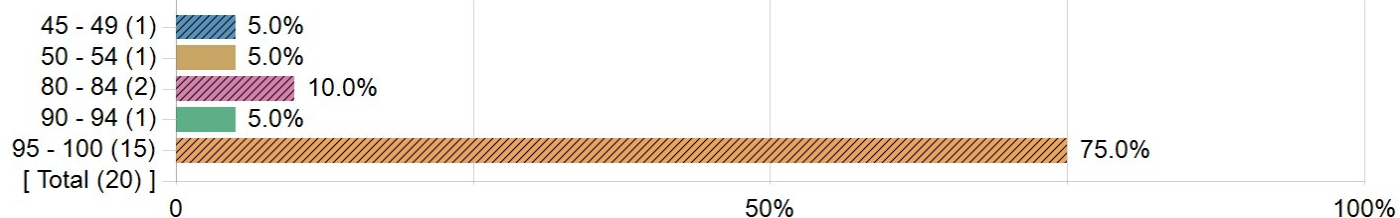
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.50

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



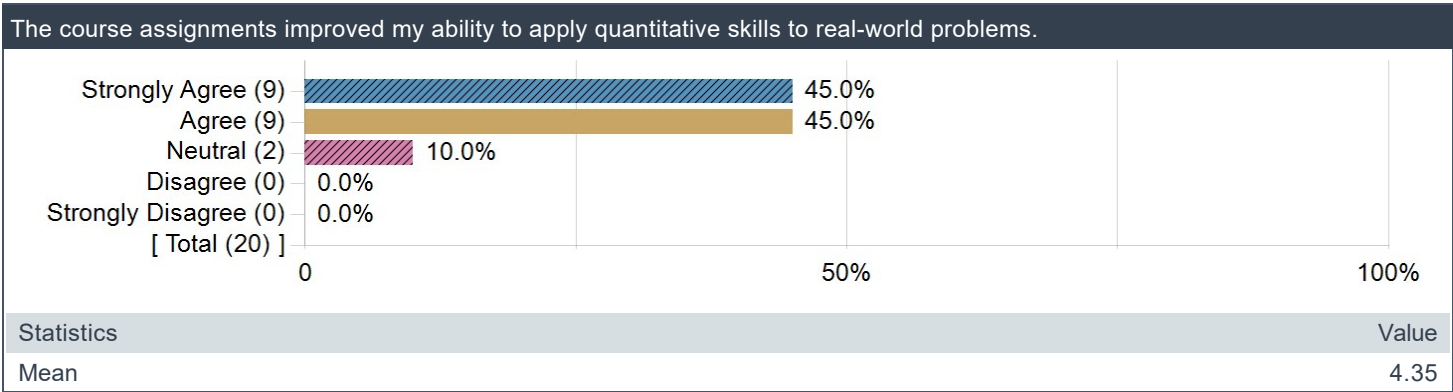
Statistics

Value

Mean

92.25

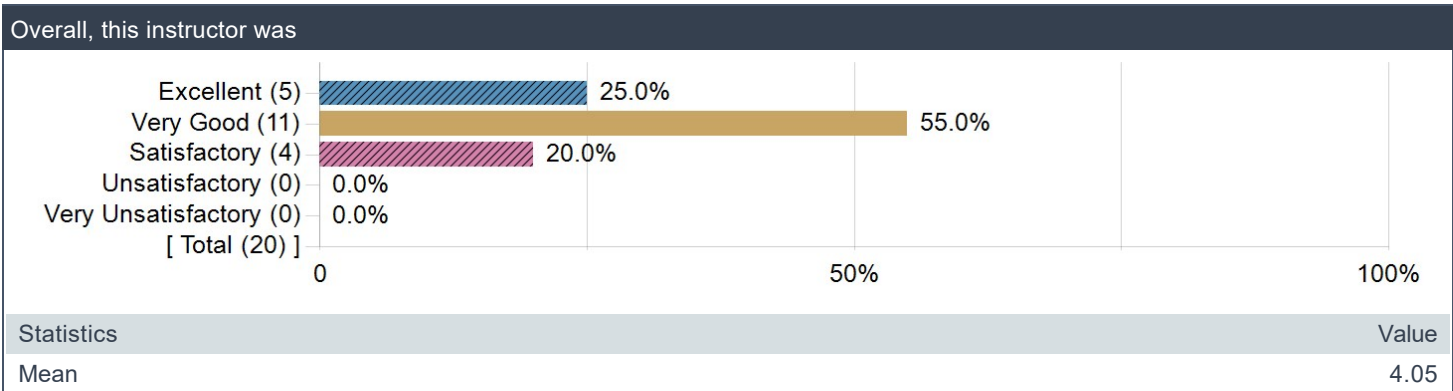
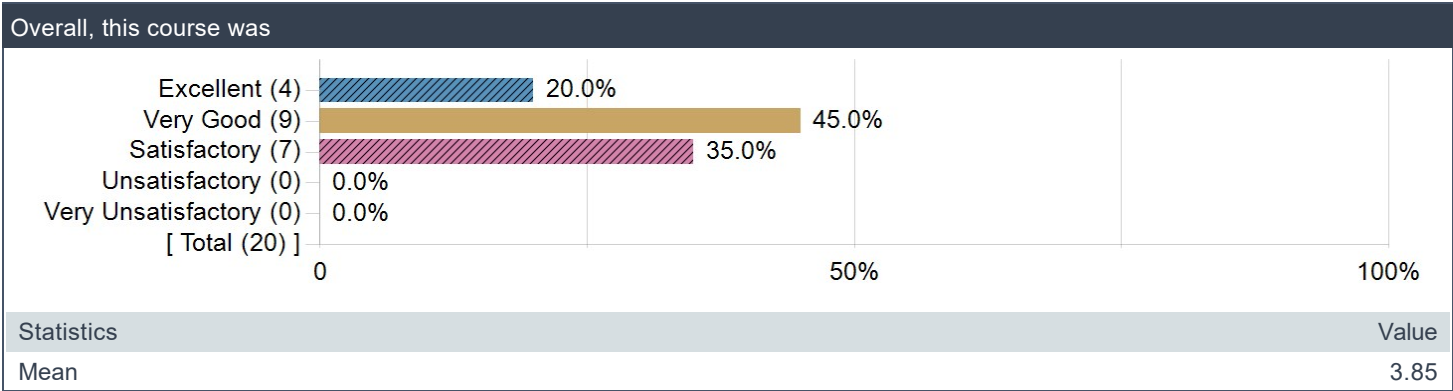
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



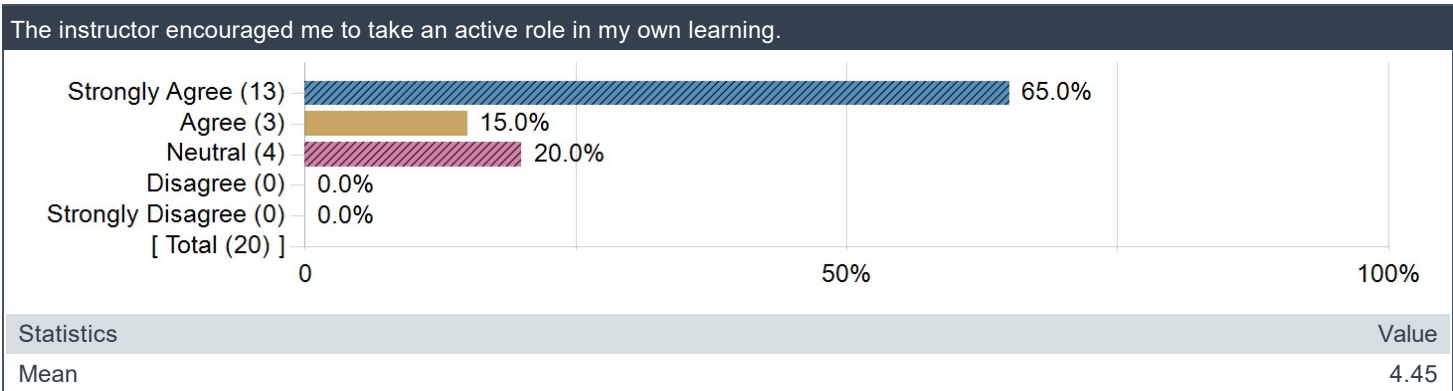
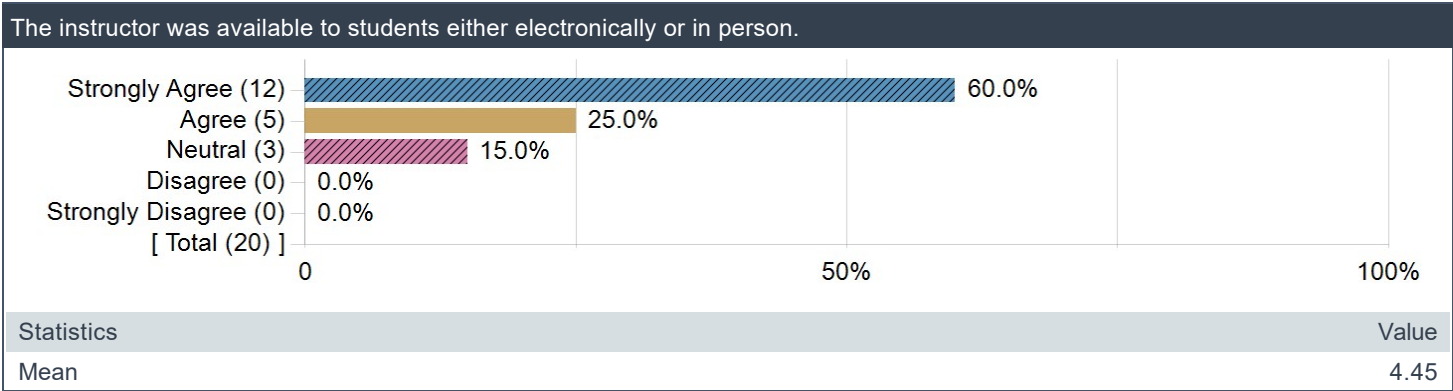
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	30.0%	60.0%	10.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20	4.20
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	35.0%	55.0%	10.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20	4.25
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	25.0%	60.0%	15.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20	4.10
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	20.0%	50.0%	30.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20	3.90
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	30.0%	45.0%	25.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20	4.05

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
The use of real-world examples allowed for a deeper understanding of complex macroeconomic concepts, making the material more relatable and engaging. Additionally, the practical problem-solving exercises encouraged critical thinking and application of economic principles, enhancing the overall learning experience.
I think the homework was a great way to hone what I have learnt
The most effective aspect of the course included having the homework assignments listed ahead of time which helps with scheduling and planning. Additionally, it was helpful in my learning to have the homework assignments paced throughout the week while also available to be completed ahead of time if necessary.
the office hours videos from the textbook and the smartwork homeworks!!
Learning
i really liked her OH
good organization, flashcard + office hour tools on canvas
Homework assignments
Homeworks, Chapter videos
The instructor was always available to answer questions during office hours.
Course was set up well.
The textbooks.
na

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
The exams were the most challenging aspect of the course due to their complexity and time constraints. To help future students meet this challenge, offering practice exams or review sessions that closely simulate the exam format and provide constructive feedback on common mistakes would greatly enhance preparation and boost performance
The two problems with the course is first having the due date for the homework at 6 clock. Personally I don't see a reason in which it isn't due at midnight. There is no grading aspect the website tells you if you are right or wrong immediately. Additionally, it is misleading to identify the course as a web-based at your own pace course, and then require students to meet every Monday at 6.
The most challenging aspect of the course is the weight of exams and their questions. The final grade of the course is heavily influenced by individual questions from the exams which results in minor mistakes being disproportionately too costly.
very fast-paced. essentially a new chapter everyday with how the homeworks were due.
Si
the price of smartwork
I felt like there really wasn't all that much lecture. A great majority of my learning came from the textbook, which I'm not a huge fan of. I like it when the two complement each other but lecture has more to offer.
The grade distribution between tests and homeworks. I believe that tests are heavily weighed hence removing incentives from students to complete the Inquizzitives.
The exams were at inconvenient times; I would have preferred to either have the exam a little later or asynchronous.
Asynchronous course, can't say there was too much done wrong.
The exams
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